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Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

THE SMILES ARE BACK

Students arrive at Indian High School in Oud Metha, Dubai campus, yesterday, as schools in the UAE resumed classes after the summer break. More than 1.277 million students streamed back into classrooms, as yellow buses rolled onto the roads and campuses across the country burst into life after two quiet summer months.

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UAE SLAMS IRAN DRONE ATTACK, CALLS IT SERIOUS ESCALATION

Gargash urges political solution; Trump warns Iran

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

The UAE strongly condemned an Iranian drone attack yesterday as a “serious escalation” and violation of its sovereignty, as the nation’s armed forces remained on full alert and US President Donald Trump threatened to hit Tehran “hard” after fighting flared again.

The Ministry of Defence said UAE air forces had dealt with a drone coming from Iran over the country’s territorial waters, while air defence systems continued to monitor the country’s airspace around the clock.

No compromise

The UAE said it would not compromise on its security and reserved its “full and legitimate right” to respond in a manner that protects its sovereignty and territorial integrity.

The UAE also dismissed as “baseless” Iran’s claim that it

had targeted US personnel at Al Minhad Air Base.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, called for “realistic and sustainable political solutions”, saying the prolonged state of “no war and no peace” could not provide a lasting way out of the crisis.

He said the policy of targeting Gulf Arab states and Jordan had “proved a failure” and argued that the political and economic dimensions of the crisis needed to be addressed together.

Immediate priority

Gargash said the immediate priority should be de-escalation and restoring normal navigation through the Strait of Hormuz, followed by a more realistic political approach that moves beyond the memorandum of understanding, which he said had failed to provide a practical and acceptable road map.

The escalation followed US strikes on two Iranian rocket launchers on Larak Island in the Strait of Hormuz on Sunday,

ending more than a month without the two sides directly trading fire.

‘Limited, precise action’

US Central Command described the operation as a “limited, precise action”, saying Revolutionary Guard forces posed an imminent threat and were preparing rockets carrying sea mines that could threaten shipping.

Iran retaliated with ballistic missile and drone attacks aimed at Jordan and the UAE, saying it was targeting US forces.

Jordan said it intercepted eight missiles, while Trump said all missiles targeting US forces were shot down except one that was determined not to pose a threat.

“We’re going to hit them hard,” Trump told Fox News. “There will be a response.”

The Iranian attacks drew condemnation from across the region, with Qatar, Kuwait, Egypt, Jordan and the GCC denouncing the escalation and backing the UAE’s sovereignty and security.

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CIO of OGold, explains
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